

LEARNING & Behavior

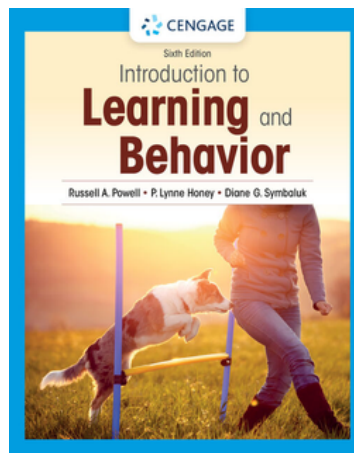
WELCOME TO LEARNING & BEHAVIOR

In this course, we'll explore how behavior is shaped through experience, drawing from foundational theories and contemporary applications in behaviorism, classical conditioning, and the science of learning. Together, we'll examine how individuals and animals adapt to their environments through processes that are both observable and deeply rooted in historical and scientific inquiry. From Skinner to Pavlov, and from theory to real-world examples—including phobias, habits, and emotional responses—you'll gain tools to analyze behavior in meaningful ways. Whether you're preparing for a career in psychology, education, health sciences, or just interested in understanding how behavior works, this course will help you think critically about why we do what we do—and how we can change it.

Course Materials

You can purchase or rent our textbook at the Baylor Bookstore or other resale websites. Our Canvas page contains additional article readings, assignments, etc.

Powell, Honey, Symbaluk. (2022).
Introduction to Learning and
Behavior (6th ed.).
Cengage Publishing. ISBN:
9780357658475



Class Meeting Info:

TR 9:30-10:45

BSB B.114

Instructor Info:



**Dr. Katherine
Blandin**

Office: BSB A. 411

Office Hours:

**W 10am-12pm,
R 2-4pm or by
appt**

Contact Your Prof:

**Email (preferred):
katie_blandin1@
baylor.edu**

Assignments

Midterm Exams (200 points)

Three midterm exams (100 points each) will be administered in the course with the lowest being dropped at the end of the semester. All exams will be administered in class, please bring a #2 pencil to class to complete the exam. Exams will consist of a mix of multiple choice, True/False, matching, and fill in the blank style questions. I will provide a scantron sheet for the exams, so you do not have to purchase your own. Please do not have any electronics, notebooks, paper, or books out on testing days. Please do not leave the classroom once the exam has begun. Once you finish the exam you will be free to leave after turning in the exam.

Final Exam (200 points)

The cumulative final exam (200 points) will consist of multiple choice questions only. Baylor policy is that you can only reschedule a final exam if you have three finals on the same day—notify the instructor and the Dean's office (Burleson 110) more than 1 month before finals.

Quizzes (100 points)

The first day we start a new chapter, with the exception of Chapter 1, we will have a brief (5 minutes) quiz at the beginning of the class. Quizzes will not be administered at the end of class or after collection of quizzes. These quizzes will be multiple choice, True/False, and fill in the blank style questions. Quizzes are worth 10 points each. There will be a total of 12 quizzes throughout the semester. You will be able to drop your lowest 2 quizzes grades, for a total of 100 possible quiz points towards your final grade.

Article discussions (100 points)

We will have 4 article discussions throughout the semester in small groups where we will analyze article relating that the current unit, each worth 25 points. Active participation and completion of discussion and critique of the article will be required and submitted to canvas on time. Article discussions will follow the intended topic for the day on the course schedule

Grading Scale

Percentage	Letter grade
$\geq 90.0\%$	A
87%-89.99%	B+
83%-86.99%	B
80%-82.99%	B-
77%-79.99%	C+
73%-76.99%	C
70%-72.99%	C-
60%-69.99%	D
$<60\%$	F

Course Policies

Laptops and Phones

The empirical literature repeatedly shows better student success when taking notes by hand than when using laptops (e.g., Mueller & Oppenheimer, 2014; Sana et al., 2013). To practice what scientists preach, and to create an environment that sets you up for success, laptops/ cell phones/ tablets are not allowed in this class. Please do not use cell phones in class. The use of a cell phone in class will count as an absence.

Respect for Others

Each student has a unique perspective and set of experiences to bring to the study of psychology. I expect each student to respect the opinions of one another, no matter how they may differ from our own.

Exam Preparation

Bring a pencil (scantron) and a pen (short answer) to each test. Tests will include both multiple choice and short answer questions and will draw upon material from both the lectures and the assigned readings. Make sure you write legibly for short answer responses. Cramming is not the best approach for success because we always under-estimate the quantity and difficulty of the material. Studying an hour every day, keeping up with the readings, practicing generating your own test questions and answering them without notes, and attending office hours is recommended for course success.

Attendance Policy

Baylor University's policy mandates attendance in 75% of classes. If you miss class/exam day, arrive late, leave before class is over, or use your cell phone during class, you will be counted as absent for that day. Being counted as absent for more than 11 classes, whether considered "excused," or "unexcused," will result in an automatic "F" for the course.

Late arrival for exams & Leaving classroom during exam

If you arrive late for an exam and a student has already left the classroom, the exam will be considered "missed" and the policy below will apply. Once the exam has begun, you should not leave the classroom and return. Therefore, you should use the restroom before each exam and bring facial tissues to class if you should need it.

Missed Exam

No makeup exams will be given. With that said the lowest midterm exam grade will be dropped to account for missed exams throughout the semester and will be reflected in the final grade at the end of the semester.

Special Considerations/ Students Needing Accommodations

Any student who needs academic accommodations related to a documented disability should inform me immediately at the beginning of the semester. You are required to obtain appropriate documentation and information regarding your accommodations from the Office of Access and Learning Accommodation (OALA). OALA is located in the basement level of the east wing of the Sid Richardson building (reachable via elevator or stairs). They can also be reached by phone (254) 710-3605 or email OALA@baylor.edu. Any student who needs academic accommodations related to a documented disability should inform me immediately at the beginning of the semester.

You are responsible for obtaining appropriate documentation and information regarding accommodations from the Office of Access and Learning Accommodation.

Academic Integrity

Academic dishonesty and any form of cheating involves a breach of student-teacher trust. Instances of plagiarism or any other act of academic dishonesty will be reported to Office of Academic Integrity, may be referred to the Honor Council for action, and may result in failure of the course. I expect you, as a Baylor student, to be intimately familiar with the Honor Code.

Academic and creative work submitted under your name is expected to be your own, neither composed by anyone else as a whole or in part, nor handed over to another party for complete or partial revision. Be sure to document all ideas that are not your own. Furthermore, in your completion of course work and assignments you must not use technologies which give you an unfair academic advantage for this course unless they have been explicitly permitted by me. In addition, providing course materials to other students, whether individually or generally (such as online) that would enable them to gain an unfair academic advantage is an act of academic dishonesty. If you have questions about what constitutes academic integrity in this course, please contact me

Honor's Contract

Honor's contract inquiries must be made by Friday of the first week of class.

Title IX Office

If you or someone you know would like help related to an experience involving:

1. Sexual assault, sex-based harassment or discrimination, dating violence, domestic violence, stalking, sexual exploitation, or retaliation for reporting one of these types of prohibited conduct, please visit www.baylor.edu/titleix, or contact us at (254) 710-8454, or TitleIX_Coordinator@baylor.edu.
2. Harassment or discrimination (excluding those issues listed in #1) based on Protected Characteristics, please visit www.baylor.edu/civilrights, or contact us at (254) 710-8454 or Civil_Rights@baylor.edu.

Academic Success

I believe every student can be successful. I sincerely want you to visit during office/student drop-in hours to discuss the course materials. Take advantage of the hours listed above or email me for an appointment. If you are struggling early in my course, I will submit an Academic Warning to the Success Center during the sixth week of the semester. That is not meant to be punitive, it is meant to get you the resources you need to succeed. More information is available at: www.baylor.edu/successcenter/

Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Other Technologies

Unless I instruct you otherwise, all assignments should be your original work and should not be produced in part or in total with the assistance of artificial intelligence (for example, ChatGPT, Grammarly, or some other resource). Use of artificial intelligence without explicit permission from the instructor constitutes a violation of the Honor Code at Baylor University. I [may or will] at times use artificial intelligence and other technologies for instruction or allow or expect you to use them to complete your assignments, but in these instances I will provide clear permission and guidance for their proper use.

Lab Course

PSY/NSC 3323 has an affiliated lab course. You will receive separate grades for each.

Classroom Community

Everyone deserves to be treated with respect and dignity in this classroom space: students, teaching assistants, instructors, and guests. Baylor's Code of Ethics ([BU-PP 024](#)) states, "Members of the Baylor University community are expected to act in a way that builds a distinctive sense of caring, kindness, mutual respect, collegiality, and fairness. The idea that the Baylor community is a family has always been vital in our historical traditions, and we here reaffirm our commitment to that idea. Out of respect for this community, we do not slander or defame." Incivility, unkindness, and aggression have no place in our classroom community.

Final Notes

N.B. I reserve the right to make any necessary changes to the policies and schedule at any time

Date	Topic
T 1/20	Introduction to the course and each other; Chapter 1: Introduction
R 1/22	Chapter 1: Introduction; 2: Research Methods
T 1/27	Chapter 2: Research Methods
R 1/29	Chapter 3: Elicited Behaviors
T 2/3	Chapter 3: Classical Conditioning
R 2/5	Chapter 4: Classical Conditioning: Basic Phenomena; article discussion #1
T 2/10	Chapter 4: Classical Conditioning: Practical Applications
R 2/12	Exam 1 (chapters 1-4)
T 2/17	Chapter 5: Classical Conditioning: Underlying Processes
R 2/19	Chapter 5: Classical Conditioning: Practical Applications

T 2/24	Chapter 6: Operant Conditioning: Introduction
R 2/26	Chapter 6 Positive Reinforcement; article discussion #2
T 3/3	Chapter 7: Schedules, theories of Reinforcement
R 3/5	Chapter 8: Extinction
T-R 3/9-3/13	No class: Spring break
T 3/17	Chapter 8: Stimulus Control
R 3/19	Chapter 9: Escape, Avoidance; article discussion #3
T 3/24	Chapter 9: Punishment
R 3/26	Exam 2 (Chapter 5-9)
T 3/31	Chapter 10: Choice, Matching
R 4/2	Chapter 10: Self-Control
T 4/7	Chapter 10: Self-Control
R 4/9	Chapter 11: Observational Learning; article discussion #4
T 4/14	<i>No class- Diadeloso</i>
R 4/16	Chapter 11: Rule-Governed Behavior

T 4/21	Chapter 12: Biological Disposition in Learning
R 4/23	Chapter 12: Biological Disposition in Learning
T 4/28	Chapter 13: Comparative Cognition
R 4/30	Chapter 13: Comparative Cognition
T 5/5	<i>Exam 3 (Chapters 10-13)</i>
M 5/11	<i>Final Exam from 4:30-6:30 pm</i>